

72nd BPSC PRELIMS

प्रहार

Test Series

Test- 09

Current Affairs

Solution

English



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BPSC TEST-9 (SOLUTION)

Q 1. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The “Niveshak Shivir” (Investor Camp) is a collaborative nationwide initiative launched by the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (IEPFA), a statutory body under the Ministry of Corporate Affairs and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI).
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Niveshak Shivir is to eliminate intermediaries (like unauthorised agents or brokers). By setting up these helpdesks, the camps allow investors to have direct, face-to-face interactions with company representatives and Registrars and Transfer Agents (RTAs). This provides on-the-spot support for KYC updation, nomination filings, and immediate grievance redressal.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Shareholders whose shares are due for transfer to the IEPFA can seek assistance based on their holding type. Those holding dematerialised shares should contact the respective company for clarification and support, while holders of physical share certificates should check their status on the IEPFA website and, if already transferred, initiate a claim by filing Form IEPF-5.

About IEPFA

- The Government of India established the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (IEPFA) under the Ministry of Corporate Affairs. Its mandate is to promote investor awareness, ensure effective grievance redressal, and facilitate the recovery of unclaimed investments through accessible and user-friendly platforms.

Q 2. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The 38th meeting of the Central Apprenticeship Council, chaired by the Minister of State (Independent Charge) for the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, recommended a 36% increase in stipends under the National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme and the National Apprenticeship Training Scheme.

Q 3. Ans. D

Explanation:

- India's first Artificial Intelligence-focused Special Economic Zone (AI-based SEZ) is being established in Nava Raipur, Chhattisgarh. The project is being

developed by RackBank Datacenters Pvt. Ltd., a company known for building carbon-neutral data centres. With an investment of nearly ₹1,000 crore, the SEZ aims to promote advanced AI infrastructure, data processing, and technological innovation, marking a significant step in India's digital and AI-driven development.

Q 4. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Sustainability in the Spice Sector through Progressive, Innovative, and Collaborative Interventions for Export Development (SPICED) is a scheme launched by the Spices Board under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. It provides financial assistance through various components to promote sustainability, innovation, and export growth in India's spices sector.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The scheme offers financial support to farmers and Farmer Producer Organisations for purchasing essential post-harvest equipment such as spice polishers, turmeric boilers, mint distillation units, and threshing machines.

Q 5. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The Department of Pharmaceuticals has announced a fresh rollout of the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme covering 11 products.
- The pharma products include Neomycin, Gentamycin, Erythromycin, Streptomycin, Tetracycline, Ciprofloxacin and Diclofenac Sodium
- The primary aim of this PLI scheme is to boost the manufacturing of critical key starting materials
- (KSMs), during Intermediates (DIs), and active pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs).

Q 6. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The “Bird-wing” event refers to a massive solar eruption observed by NASA satellites. It gained this name due to its visually striking shape, where superheated plasma tore away from the Sun's northern hemisphere in sweeping, wing-like formations.
- The event was a complex eruption involving both a Solar Flare (a burst of electromagnetic radiation) and a Coronal Mass Ejection (CME) (a massive cloud of magnetised plasma).

Q 7. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The SWOT (Surface Water and Ocean Topography) Satellite is a collaborative mission between NASA and the French space agency CNES. Other international partners have also contributed to the mission. It was launched to improve scientific understanding of Earth's surface water and ocean systems.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** SWOT satellite can detect and measure small variations in water height across oceans, rivers, lakes, and reservoirs. These measurements help in studying sea-level rise, water management, climate change, and flood forecasting.

Q 8. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** DHRUVA was released by the Department of Posts, not the Department of Telecommunications. It is a policy framework for creating a national Digital Address Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for India.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The idea of Address-as-a-Service (AaaS) is central to DHRUVA. It enables citizens, corporations, and governmental organisations to share verified address data in real time, with consent.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** DHRUVA aims to create a collaborative ecosystem involving both government and private sector stakeholders. It supports secure, consent-based sharing of address data rather than restricting it only to government agencies.

Q 9. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** BharatGen is India's first indigenous multimodal Artificial Intelligence initiative. It has been developed to provide AI-based solutions across 22 Indian languages, thereby addressing India's linguistic diversity. It is developed under the National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (NM-ICPS) and implemented through TIH Foundation for IoT and IoE at IIT Bombay.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** BharatGen aims to revolutionise AI development across India's linguistic and cultural spectrum. The initiative is supported by the Department of Science and Technology (DST) and brings together a robust consortium of leading academic institutions, experts, and innovators.

Q 10. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- The C-CARES Version 2.0 (Coal Mines Provident Fund Organisation Computerisation of Accounts and Records Electronic System) web portal was launched by the Union Minister of Coal and Mines. The technology was developed by the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC). The Organisation is presently rendering services to about 3.3 lakh Provident Fund subscribers and 6.3 lakh pensioners of coal sector.

Q 11. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Bharat Forecast System (BFS) is a high-resolution weather forecasting model that delivers forecasts at an ultra-fine spatial resolution of 6 km. This gives India an advantage over several global forecasting systems that generally operate at resolutions between 9 and 14 km.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The BFS was developed indigenously by the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune. It represents an important achievement under the Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative in climate science and weather forecasting.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The BFS replaced the earlier 12-km resolution forecasting model, not a 20-km model. The upgraded system is now operational at the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

Q 12. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Researchers from the Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences (SKUAST), Srinagar, have developed India's first gene-edited sheep. Achieved after four years of research, the gene-editing is expected to increase the animal's muscle mass by about 30%. This breakthrough follows the recent development of India's first gene-edited rice variety.

Q 13. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Axiom Mission 4 (Ax-4) is the fourth private astronaut mission to the International Space Station and is being organised by Axiom Space in partnership with NASA, SpaceX, and ISRO. The mission reflects growing international and commercial cooperation in space exploration.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The major objectives of Ax-4 is to carry out scientific research in microgravity conditions. The experiments focus on areas such as materials science, biology, Earth observation, and life sciences, along with promoting commercial activities in low Earth orbit.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Ax-4 does not mark India's first human spaceflight mission. India had already sent Rakesh Sharma to space in 1984 aboard a Soviet mission. However, Ax-4 is significant because it marks India's return to human spaceflight after 41 years.

Q 14. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Researchers in Japan have developed a plastic that dissolves in seawater within hours, offering up a potential solution for a modern-day scourge polluting oceans and harming wildlife.
- It is a supramolecular polymer made from a combination of sodium hexametaphosphate (a common food additive) and guanidinium-based monomers.

Q 15. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Shirui Lily Festival was recently inaugurated in the state of Manipur. The festival is associated with the famous Shirui Lily, a rare flower found only on the Shirui Hills in the Ukhrul district of Manipur. Blooming mainly between late May and early June, the flower has gained international recognition because of its uniqueness and limited geographical distribution.
- The festival is organised to promote the cultural heritage, tourism potential, and ecological importance of the region, while also encouraging eco-tourism and local development

Q 16. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Sagarmatha Sambaad concluded in Kathmandu with the adoption of the 'Sagarmatha Call for Action'—a comprehensive and urgent appeal to the international community to address the escalating climate crisis, with an emphasis on the world's mountain ecosystems.
- Theme: 'Climate Change, Mountains, and the Future of Humanity'

Q 17. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The World Hydrogen Summit 2025 is being organised in Rotterdam,

Netherlands, a major global hub for clean energy and hydrogen-related initiatives. The summit brings together governments, industries, and experts to discuss developments in the hydrogen economy.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** India has announced the goal of achieving energy independence by 2047, coinciding with 100 years of independence, and has also committed to achieving net-zero carbon emissions by 2070 as part of its climate commitments.

Q 18. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The Zangezur Corridor will provide uninterrupted transportation between the main territory of the Republic of Azerbaijan and the Nakhchivan Autonomous Republic, while also serving as a vital new segment of both the East-West and North-South transport corridors.
- The project will enhance integration across the Turkic World, foster a new era of regional economic collaboration, and establish a strategic link on the Eurasian logistics network.

Q 19. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Clean Plant Programme was announced during India's first International Agri Hackathon held in Pune.
- The programme aims to provide disease-free planting material for important horticultural crops. In its initial phase, it focuses on grapes, oranges, and pomegranates, which are major fruit crops of Maharashtra. The initiative is expected to improve crop quality, productivity, and farmers' income, and will later be expanded across India.

Q 20. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Bharat Seva Kendra (BSK) and similar Digital India initiatives like Common Service Centres (CSCs) aim to deliver G2C and B2C services to rural and remote areas. They help bridge the urban-rural digital divide by providing citizens easy access to digital services, certificates, and welfare schemes at the local level.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Bharat Seva Kendras are service delivery points, not regulatory bodies. They act as facilitators for services like Aadhaar registration, utility bill payments, and banking through the Business Correspondent (BC) model.

Q 21. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The Kamalpur Nagar Panchayat in the Dhalai district of Tripura has gained national attention for its proactive measures against single-use plastic (SUP). To provide a sustainable alternative, they have introduced compostable bags specifically manufactured using Polybutylene Adipate Terephthalate (PBAT).
- Polybutylene Adipate Terephthalate: It is a biodegradable and compostable random copolymer. Unlike traditional plastics like PET or HDPE, which are derived from petroleum and persist in the environment for centuries, PBAT is designed to break down fully in composting conditions without leaving toxic residues.

Q 22. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Innovation in Science Pursuit for Inspired Research (INSPIRE) is a flagship program of the Department of Science & Technology (DST). Its core objective is to attract talent to the study of science at an early age and build the required critical human resource pool for strengthening the Science & Technology (S&T) system and R&D base.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** A unique feature of the INSPIRE programme is that it does not conduct competitive exams for selection. Instead, it relies on the efficacy of the existing educational structure for identification of talent. For example, the INSPIRE Award-MANAK is based on school-level nominations, and the Scholarship for Higher Education (SHE) is based on performance in Board exams (Top 1% of State/Central Boards) or top ranks in national exams like JEE or NEET.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The scheme covers a wide age group (10–32 years) and is divided into three major components to ensure a continuous pipeline of talent:
 - ✓ SEATS (Scheme for Early Attraction of Talent): Focuses on school students (Class 6-10).
 - ✓ SHE (Scholarship for Higher Education): Focuses on students pursuing Bachelor and Masters level education in Natural Sciences.
 - ✓ AORC (Assured Opportunity for Research Careers): Focuses on the PhD and Post-doctoral stages through Fellowships and Faculty awards.

Q 23. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The Waste Picker Enumeration App was launched by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment on the occasion of World Environment Day 2025 to formally identify and profile waste pickers across the country.
- Its main objective is to integrate waste pickers into welfare and social security measures under the NAMASTE Scheme (National Action for Mechanised Sanitation Ecosystem). The initiative aims to improve their livelihood, dignity, health coverage, and access to government benefits.

Q 24. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** INSV Kaundinya is an Indian Navy Sailing Vessel built with a design inspired by ancient Indian maritime heritage. Specifically, its structure and aesthetic cues draw inspiration from a fifth-century ship illustrated in the world-famous Ajanta cave paintings
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The vessel is named after Kaundinya, a legendary figure often credited in historical and mythological accounts with establishing early maritime and cultural links between India and Southeast Asia (specifically the Funan Kingdom in present-day Cambodia/Vietnam). The name serves as a tribute to the ancient Indian mariners who navigated the Indian Ocean for trade and cultural exchange.

Q 25. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Operation Rising Lion was launched by Israel targeting strategic sites linked to Iran, including military and nuclear-related infrastructure. The operation gained attention due to rising tensions in West Asia and concerns over regional security.
- Strikes were aimed at critical facilities involved in uranium enrichment and weaponisation, including the Pilot Fuel Enrichment Plant (PFEP) in Natanz, the Uranium Conversion Facility (UCF) and Fuel Plate Fabrication Plant (FPFP) in Isfahan.

Q 26. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- The Global Gender Gap Index, an annual report published by the World Economic Forum (WEF).
 - ✓ Iceland → 1st

- ✓ Finland → 2nd
- ✓ Norway → 3rd
- ✓ United Kingdom → 4th
- ✓ New Zealand → 5th
- ✓ India → 131st

Q 27. Ans. B

Explanation:

- India has formally assumed the Chairmanship of the Asian Productivity Organization (APO) for the 2025–26 term during the ongoing 67th Session of the Governing Body Meeting (GBM) of the APO, being held from 20–22 May 2025 in Jakarta, Indonesia.
- India reiterated its commitment to advancing the APO Vision 2030 and expanding the Green Productivity 2.0 framework. India emphasized the importance of regional collaboration in driving digital transformation, sustainability, innovation, and entrepreneurship.

Q 28. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The first FM radio station operated by the Indian Army in Pithoragarh district of Uttarakhand was inaugurated by General Officer Commanding (GOC) of Army's Central Command Anindya Sengupta. The objective of the initiative is to create goodwill between the Indian Army and people of the border areas.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The project is a key component of Operation Sadbhavana (Operation Goodwill). This long-standing Indian Army initiative focuses on community development, education, and national integration in remote or conflict-affected areas like Jammu & Kashmir and the North Eastern states, and now increasingly in strategic border districts like Pithoragarh

Q 29. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Pyrite (The "Fool's Gold")**
 - ✓ Location: Rohtas (specifically Amjhore).
 - ✓ Significance: Bihar holds nearly 95% of India's total Pyrite resources.
- **Mica (The Great Insulator)**
 - ✓ Location: Nawada, Jamui, and Gaya.
 - ✓ Significance: This region forms the "Bihar Mica Belt." The mica found here is often of the "Muscovite" variety (Ruby Mica), which is world-renowned for its quality.

● Quartz & Quartzite

- ✓ Location: Lakhisarai, Munger, and Nalanda.
- ✓ Significance: Found in the Kharagpur hills and other southern hill ranges.

● Saltpeter (Shora)

- ✓ Location: Saran, Muzaffarpur, East Champaran, and Begusarai.
- ✓ Significance: Unlike other minerals on this list, Saltpeter is found in the North Bihar plains. It forms as a natural efflorescence on the soil in areas with high human and animal habitation.

● Limestone

- ✓ Location: Rohtas and Kaimur.
- ✓ Use: It is the most critical raw material for the Cement Industry. Major plants at Banjari and Dalmianagar were established due to the proximity of these mines.

● Gold

- ✓ Location: Jamui (Sono area).
- ✓ Significance: Based on a recent Geological Survey of India (GSI) report, Jamui is estimated to hold nearly 222.88 million tonnes of gold ore, which is about 44% of India's total gold reserves.

Q 30. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Lee Jae-myung is associated with South Korea and became its President.
- Karol Nawrocki is associated with Poland and serves as its President.
- Daniel Noboa is the President of Ecuador.
- Kamil al-Taib Idris is associated with Sudan and serves as Prime Minister.

Q 31. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Tele-density is the number of telephone connections per 100 people. In Bihar, this means roughly 36 out of every 100 people still do not have a registered telephone connection (wireless or wireline).
- According to recent telecom data, Bihar recorded the lowest tele-density among Indian states at about 63.54%.

Q 32. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Bihar became the first state in India to introduce mobile phone-based voting during municipal polls. The initiative was aimed at improving voter participation and making the electoral process more

accessible, especially for senior citizens, differently-abled persons, and migrant voters.

- The pilot project was launched during the municipal by-polls and elections across six Nagar Panchayats (including districts like Patna, Rohtas, Buxar, and East Champaran).

Q 33. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** NAVYA was launched in Sonbhadra, Uttar Pradesh by the Ministry of Women and Child Development in convergence with the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship. The programme was jointly launched by Jayant Chaudhary and Savitri Thakur.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The NAVYA programme aims to empower adolescent girls aged 16–18 years by providing vocational training, especially in non-traditional and emerging job roles, in line with the vision of Viksit Bharat@2047.

Q 34. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The 11th India Maize Summit 2025 was inaugurated by Shivraj Singh Chouhan in New Delhi. The summit was jointly organized by FICCI and the Indian Institute of Maize Research (ICAR-IIMR) to promote reforms and growth in India's maize sector.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** During the summit, a roadmap was unveiled to trigger a "Maize Revolution" in India. The country aims to increase maize production from the current level of over 42 million tonnes to 86 million tonnes by 2047. India's average maize yield is about 3.7 tonnes per hectare, which is still lower than the global average, making research, improved seeds, and farmer education important policy priorities.

Q 35. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Trinidad and Tobago became the first Caribbean nation to enable transactions through India's BHIM app using the Unified Payments Interface (UPI).
- The development reflects India's growing digital financial cooperation with other countries and highlights the global expansion of UPI-based payment systems. It is also an important step in strengthening fintech and economic ties between India and Caribbean nations.

Q 36. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Sagarmala Finance Corporation Limited (SMFCL) is India's first maritime-focused non-banking financial company (NBFC). It recently started lending operations by sanctioning loans worth around ₹4,300 crore, aimed at strengthening India's maritime finance ecosystem.
- The loan approvals were cleared during the company's 51st board meeting, marking SMFCL's formal entry into the maritime lending sector in line with its approved business strategy.

Q 37. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** C-FLOOD Platform is a Unified Inundation Forecasting System developed collaboratively by Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), Pune and the Central Water Commission under the Ministry of Jal Shakti. The initiative is implemented under the National Supercomputing Mission jointly steered by MeitY and DST.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The platform is a web-based system that provides two-day advance flood inundation forecasts up to the village level through flood maps and water level predictions. It also serves as a unified decision-support system for disaster management authorities.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Currently, the platform covers the Mahanadi, Godavari, and Tapi river basins, not the Ganga, Brahmaputra, and Narmada basins.

Q 38. Ans. A

Explanation:

- In cloud seeding, substances such as silver iodide, potassium iodide, dry ice (solid CO₂), and salt particles are used to stimulate rainfall. Among these, silver iodide is widely used because its structure closely resembles natural ice crystals, allowing it to act as an artificial ice nucleus in supercooled clouds.

Q 39. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Haryana government is developing the Aravalli Jungle Safari as Asia's largest jungle safari in the Aravalli region covering parts of Gurgaon and Nuh districts. The project is planned over nearly 10,000 acres, and in the first

phase international-level facilities will be developed across about 2,500 acres.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The safari project is also linked with the Aravali Green Wall Project through the 'Matru Van' campaign, under which around 20,000 trees are proposed to be planted to enhance greenery and support ecological conservation in the region.

Q 40. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has built the country's first dedicated wildlife corridor on a national highway. This significant move of building this 12-kilometre stretch that blends wildlife conservation with modern infrastructure is part of the Delhi–Mumbai Expressway and passes through the buffer zone of the Ranthambore Tiger Reserve

Q 41. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Nistar is the first indigenously designed and constructed Diving Support Vessel (DSV) delivered to the Indian Navy by Hindustan Shipyard Limited in July 2025. This marks a significant step toward indigenous defence manufacturing under initiatives like Aatmanirbhar Bharat.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The vessel is capable of Deep Sea Saturation Diving up to 300 m depth, not 1500 m. Additionally, it supports:
 - ✓ Diving operations up to 75 m using a side diving stage
 - ✓ Salvage and monitoring operations up to 1000 m using Remotely Operated Vehicles (ROVs)

Q 42. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct.** INS Tamal (F 71) was commissioned on 01 July 2025 at Yantar Shipyard, marking its formal induction into the Indian Navy. It is the eighth stealth frigate of Project 1135.6 and part of the Tushil-class follow-on ships.
- **Statement 2 is correct.** The ship is equipped with advanced weaponry and systems, including the BrahMos supersonic cruise missile and the HumSANG sonar system, reflecting a blend of Indian and Russian technologies. It also carries vertical-launched surface-to-air missiles (Shtil-1), torpedoes, and advanced electronic warfare systems.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect.** The ship does not have

100% indigenous components; instead, it has about 26% indigenous content. However, this still represents a significant step toward self-reliance under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative.

Q 43. Ans. B

Explanation:

- IFFCO to set up its first overseas nano fertiliser plant in Brazil via joint venture with NANO FERT. The facility will produce 4.5 million litres annually, boosting global reach and reducing costs. Nano fertilisers show promise in boosting crop yields while cutting conventional fertiliser use.

Q 44. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The "Order of the Most Ancient Welwitschia Mirabilis" is not Brazil's highest civilian honour; it is the highest civilian award of Namibia. It was recently conferred on Narendra Modi by Namibia's President, making him the first Indian recipient.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The "Grand Collar of the National Order of the Southern Cross" is not conferred by Namibia; it is the highest civilian honour of Brazil. It was also awarded to Narendra Modi by the Brazilian President in recognition of his role in strengthening bilateral and global cooperation.

Q 45. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Parag Jain (Chief of RAW):** Senior IPS officer Parag Jain (a 1989-batch officer of the Punjab cadre) was appointed as the 25th Secretary of the Research and Analysis Wing (RAW), succeeding Ravi Sinha.
- **Kavinder Gupta (L-G of Ladakh):** The former Deputy Chief Minister of Jammu & Kashmir was appointed as the Lieutenant Governor of the Union Territory of Ladakh by President Droupadi Murmu in July 2025. He was subsequently shifted to serve as the Governor of Himachal Pradesh, with Vinai Kumar Saxena taking over Ladakh.
- **Ashok Gajapathi Raju (Governor of Goa):** The senior Telugu Desam Party (TDP) leader and former Union Minister for Civil Aviation was appointed as the Governor of Goa
- **Ashim Kumar Ghosh (Governor of Haryana):** Professor Ashim Kumar Ghosh, a renowned academician and former president of the BJP's West Bengal unit, was appointed as the 19th Governor of Haryana by President Droupadi Murmu.

Q 46. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **“Woman! Life! Freedom!:** Echoes of a Revolutionary Uprising in Iran”: Authored by anthropologist and researcher Chowra Makaremi.
- **History That India Ignored:** Written by veteran journalist and ANI founder Prem Prakash. It is one of the notable literature releases of early 2026, focusing on overlooked historical narratives.
- **A Different Kind of Power:** This is a highly publicised memoir by the former Prime Minister of New Zealand, Jacinda Ardern (full name: Jacinda Kate Laurell Ardern). It was also shortlisted for the 2026 Ockham New Zealand Book Awards.
- **Swasthya Ke Prahari:** Authored by Lalit Shaurya. This is a children’s health-awareness book that was officially launched by Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami to promote health and well-being among the youth.

Q 47. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Bonn Climate Change Conference (2025) – Germany:**
 - ✓ The 62nd sessions of the Subsidiary Bodies (SB 62) to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) were held in Bonn, Germany, in June 2025. It is the permanent headquarters of the UNFCCC Secretariat, making it the customary host for these critical preparatory meetings leading up to the COP summits.
- **51st G7 Summit – Canada:**
 - ✓ The 51st G7 Summit took place in June 2025 in Kananaskis, Alberta, Canada. The G7 presidency rotates annually among member states, and Canadian official government records confirm Canada assumed the host presidency for 2025 following Italy’s turn in 2024.
- **22nd SCO Defence Ministers’ Meeting – India :**
 - ✓ This meeting was actually held in Qingdao, China, in June 2025. Official press releases from the Ministry of Defence confirm that India’s Defence Minister Rajnath Singh traveled to Qingdao to participate, where he notably opted out of signing the joint statement due to its omission of explicit references to terrorism.
- **NATO Summit (2026) – Türkiye:**
 - ✓ The 2026 NATO Summit is scheduled to be held in Ankara, Türkiye. This has been officially

confirmed by the Republic of Türkiye’s Presidential Communications Directorate and aligns with NATO’s official summit schedule.

Q 48. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Kirsty Coventry, a seven-time Olympic medalist from Zimbabwe, made history when she was elected as the 10th President of the International Olympic Committee (IOC), officially taking office. This landmark achievement made her the very first female President, as well as the first African President, in the organization’s history.

Q 49. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The first-ever ASEAN–India Cruise Dialogue was hosted by India in Chennai. The event marked a significant step toward strengthening maritime and cruise tourism cooperation in the Indo-Pacific region.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The dialogue was organised by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways under the leadership of Sarbananda Sonowal. It focused on enhancing cruise connectivity, port infrastructure, and sustainable tourism.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The event witnessed participation from all ASEAN member nations—Brunei, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, and Vietnam—along with Timor Leste, reflecting broad regional engagement.

Q 50. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- Indonesia officially became a full member of BRICS. The 17th BRICS Summit, hosted by Brazil in Rio de Janeiro in July 2025, marked Indonesia’s first summit participation as a full member state.
- The UN Security Council Presidency for July 2025 was held by Pakistan, not Suriname. The presidency rotates monthly in English alphabetical order among the 15 member states.
- Suriname became the first country in the Amazon region to receive malaria-free certification from the World Health Organisation (WHO).

Q 51. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Broadcasting Infrastructure and Network Development (BIND)

Scheme is a Central Sector Scheme approved by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs. It aims to provide financial support for the expansion and upgradation of public broadcasting infrastructure.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The BIND Scheme will increase coverage of AIR FM transmitters in the country to 66% by geographical area and 80% by population up from 59% and 68% respectively. The Scheme also envisages free distribution of over 8 lakh DD Free Dish STBs to people living in remote, tribal, LWE and border areas.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The BIND Scheme itself does not operate broadcasting services. Instead, Prasar Bharati is the statutory body that operates Doordarshan (DD) and All India Radio (AIR) as India's public broadcasters, while the scheme only provides financial and infrastructural support.

Q 52. Ans. B

Explanation:

- India's first wooden Gurudwara, 'Sri Nanak Niwas', was recently inaugurated in Punjab, specifically at Fazilka police lines. The structure is uniquely built using imported Deodhar wood, making it distinct in architectural style.
- The idea for the Gurudwara was initiated by Bhupinder Singh Sidhu, who envisioned a dedicated place of worship within the police premises after noticing the absence of such a facility for residents and visitors.

Q 53. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **46th ASEAN Summit:**
 - ✓ Theme: Inclusivity and Sustainability
 - ✓ Malaysia assumed the ASEAN Chairmanship for 2025
- **55th Annual Meeting of the World Economic Forum:**
 - ✓ Theme: Collaboration for the Intelligent Age
- **International Olympic Day:**
 - ✓ Theme: Let's Move
 - ✓ International Olympic Committee (IOC) and the World Health Organization (WHO) confirm the continuation of the "Let's Move" initiative for 2025 to promote daily physical activity globally.
- **Trade Facilitation Conference 2025:**
 - ✓ Theme: Scientific Excellence for Seamless Trade

Q 54. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited (Tata Power-DDL), a leading power utility supplying electricity to over 2 million customers in North Delhi and Nissin Electric Co. Ltd. – Kyoto (Japan) based leading electric equipment company, will kick-start a demonstration project to supply electricity from India's first Micro Substation with Power Voltage Transformer (PVT) to ensure stable power for areas without a power grid.

Q 55. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Sahitya Akademi officially confers its annual literary awards, including the Bal Sahitya Puraskar, across 24 recognised Indian languages. This includes the 22 languages enumerated in the Eighth Schedule of the Indian Constitution, plus English and Rajasthani. For the 2025 cycle, exactly 24 writers were selected, covering all 24 languages.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Author Sushil Shukla was awarded the Bal Sahitya Puraskar 2025 in the Hindi language for his literary work titled Ek Batey Bara.
 - ✓ The other awardees include Surendra Mohan Das for Mainaahantar Padya (Assamese, poetry), Tridib Kumar Chattopadhyay for Ekhono Gaye Kanta Daye (Bengali, stories), Binay Kumar Brahma for Khanthi Bwswan Arw Akhu Danai (Bodo, stories), P.L. Parihar 'Shauq' for Nanhi Tor (Dogri, poetry), Nitin Kushalappa MP for Dakshin: South Indian Myths and Fables Retold (English, stories), and Kirtida Brahmabhatt for Tinchak (Gujarati, poetry).

Q 56. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Asia Rugby Under-20 (Sevens) Championship was hosted at the newly developed State Sports Academy in Rajgir. It marked the first-ever international rugby event held in the state.
- An International Sugarcane Research Centre is being established at Pusa, which is located in the Samastipur district. This centre is part of a broader government initiative to modernise sugarcane cultivation, develop high-yield seed varieties, and provide advanced digital guidance to farmers.

- The new Lion Breeding Centre in Bihar is being developed at the Rajgir Zoo Safari, not in Patna. Recent animal exchange programs were executed specifically to establish Rajgir as a premier Asian Lion breeding hub.

Q 57. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Palna Scheme (formerly known as the National Creche Scheme) is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme under the 'Samarthya' sub-scheme of the overarching 'Mission Shakti' initiative. The official funding ratio is 60:40 between the Centre and standard States/UTs with legislatures, 90:10 for North Eastern and Special Category States, and 100% central funding for UTs without a legislature.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Palna Scheme does not cater to children up to 14 years of age. The official objective of the Palna scheme is to provide safe day-care crèche facilities, cognitive development, nutritional support, and immunisation specifically for children in the age group of 6 months to 6 years. This age bracket is targeted to ensure critical early childhood care while freeing mothers from unpaid childcare responsibilities to pursue gainful employment.

Q 58. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The "Meri Panchayat" mobile application received the WSIS Prizes 2025 Champion Award during the WSIS+20 High-Level Event 2025, organised by the International Telecommunication Union.
- This prestigious event was held in Geneva, which serves as the headquarters of the ITU and a major global hub for international governance and digital policy discussions.
- The recognition highlights India's progress in digital governance and local content empowerment, especially at the grassroots Panchayat level.

Q 59. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Gujarat has become the first Indian State to launch a genome sequencing initiative focused exclusively on tribal communities. The Tribal Genome Sequencing Project was announced with the aim of identifying genetic health risks and enabling precision healthcare for tribal populations. The initiative will sequence the genomes of 2,000

individuals from tribal communities across 17 districts in the State.

Q 60. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Tuvalu is a small island country located in the Pacific Ocean, situated between Hawaii and Australia. It consists of low-lying atolls and is highly vulnerable to rising sea levels.
- Tuvalu has recently been in the news for initiating a climate-induced migration programme, becoming one of the first countries to plan state-backed relocation of its population due to climate change impacts.

Q 61. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Kashi Declaration was formally adopted at the Youth Spiritual Summit held in Varanasi. The summit was organised by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports on the theme "Nasha Mukta Yuva for Viksit Bharat", bringing together youth leaders, spiritual organisations, and experts.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Kashi Declaration outlines a collective national commitment to build a drug-free society by 2047, aligning with India's vision of a Viksit Bharat (Developed India). It focuses on youth-led awareness, prevention, and rehabilitation strategies.

Q 62. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct.** Samudra Prachet is the second and final Pollution Control Vessel (PCV) constructed by Goa Shipyard Limited for the Indian Coast Guard.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect.** The vessel is not a submarine rescue ship and does not undertake deep-sea diving operations. It is specifically designed for pollution control and oil spill response, not underwater rescue missions. The vessel is engineered to recover oil across the full viscosity spectrum, pump in contaminated water, analyse and separate pollutants, and store recovered oil in dedicated onboard tanks.
- **Statement 3 is correct.** The vessel is equipped with advanced oil spill response systems, including side-sweeping arms, oil recovery mechanisms, and storage tanks, enabling it to operate in India's Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) for environmental protection and maritime pollution control.

Q 63. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** India successfully tested its first hydrogen-powered coach (Driving Power Car) at the Integral Coach Factory (ICF), Chennai. This marks a major step in India's green rail innovation and is part of Indian Railways' broader plan to develop hydrogen-based trains, including the vision of deploying 35 hydrogen-powered trains under the "Hydrogen for Heritage" initiative.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The 15th Conference of the Parties (COP15) to the Ramsar Convention on Wetlands was held in Zimbabwe. The conference brought together governments, civil society, and international organisations to reaffirm global commitments toward the conservation and wise use of wetlands and to address emerging environmental challenges.

Q 64. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement A is correct:** The Udyam Sakhi Portal is an initiative of the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) aimed at supporting women entrepreneurs. It was launched in March 2018 to provide information about various government schemes, policies, and programmes that can help women start, build, and grow their businesses.
- **Statement B is correct:** The portal assists women entrepreneurs by providing useful information related to business development, including guidance on preparing business plans and details of nodal offices and supporting organisations under the MSME Ministry and other Central Ministries.
- **Statement C is incorrect:** The Udyam Sakhi Portal does not disburse loans or financial assistance directly. Instead, it only provides information about financial schemes such as PMEGP, CGTMSE, and MUDRA, which are implemented through banks and other financial intermediaries.
- **Statement D is correct:** The portal helps women to start, build and grow their businesses. A total of 4207 women have so far registered on the portal, out of which 943 women belong to the State of Bihar.

Q 65. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Yulia Anatoliivna Svyrydenko (PM of Ukraine):** She officially took office as the 19th Prime Minister of Ukraine, replacing Denys Shmyhal.

- **Justin Nsengiyumva (PM of Rwanda):** The Rwandan-British economist and former Deputy Governor of the National Bank of Rwanda was appointed as the Prime Minister of Rwanda by President Paul Kagame. He succeeded Edouard Ngirente.
- **Vaishali Nigam Sinha (President, UNGCNI):** The Co-Founder of ReNew was elected as the President of the UN Global Compact Network India (UNGCNI). She is notably the first private sector leader to hold this position since the network's inception.
- **Prof. Michele Dougherty (Astronomer Royal, UK):** The eminent Professor of Space Physics at Imperial College London was appointed as the UK's Astronomer Royal. She is the first woman to hold this prestigious advisory role to the monarch in its 350-year history.

Q 66. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Goa (First Ro-Ro service on Mandovi River):** The Government of Goa, through its River Navigation Department, officially commissioned the state's first Roll-on-Roll-off (Ro-Ro) ferry service. The vessels, named Gangotri and Dwarka, operate on the Mandovi River to connect Chorao Island directly with Panaji, heavily reducing commute times.
- **Sonapur (India's first Aqua Tech Park):** India's first Water Technology Park (the Kalong Kapili Aqua Tech Park) in Sonapur, near Guwahati. This pioneering aquaculture hub was developed in direct collaboration with the state fisheries department and the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD).
- **Maharashtra (Agricultural status to livestock and poultry):** Maharashtra is the first state in the country to grant formal "agricultural status" to livestock and poultry farming. This administrative shift allows livestock farmers to access the exact same electricity tariffs, local body tax exemptions, and loan structures as traditional crop farmers.
- **Gujarat (Genome sequencing for tribal communities):** The Gujarat Biotechnology Research Centre (GBRC)—an autonomous body under the Department of Science and Technology, Government of Gujarat—to launch India's first large-scale genome sequencing project specifically focused on mapping the DNA of tribal populations across 17 districts to combat hereditary disorders like sickle cell anaemia and thalassemia.

Q 67. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- **Poligras Magic Skill Award (Deepika):** Indian women's hockey forward Deepika won the Poligras Magic Skill Award in July 2025 for her spectacular solo goal against the Netherlands in the FIH Hockey Pro League.
- **Kalinga Ratna Award (Dharmendra Pradhan):** The Union Education Minister was conferred the Kalinga Ratna Award 2024. The ceremony took place in Cuttack to mark the 600th birth anniversary of Odia poet Adikabi Sarala Das.
- **Sant Kabir Handloom Award (Lakka Sreenivasulu):** The master weaver from Venkatagiri, Andhra Pradesh, was honored with the prestigious Sant Kabir Award (the highest national honor in textiles/handlooms) for creating a rare, dual-sided reversible saree using cruelty-free 'Booda silk' and 2% gold/silver threads.
- **Best Magic Creator (Suhani Shah):** The renowned mentalist became the first Indian to win the "Best Magic Creator 2025" award at the FISM World Championship of Magic (widely regarded as the 'Oscars of Magic') held in Turin, Italy.

Q 68. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Israel's first fully government-funded and locally-made communication satellite was launched from Cape Canaveral in the US on a SpaceX Falcon-9 rocket. Such geostationary satellites remain stationary at a fixed point about 36,000 km above the Earth.
- Dror-1 has strengthened Israel's sovereignty, self-reliance and strategic control. Its cost has been estimated to be around Rs 1,670 crore.

Q 69. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **National Handloom Day (August 7):** The Government of India officially declared August 7 as National Handloom Day to commemorate the Swadeshi Movement which was launched on this day in 1905.
✓ The theme of National Handloom Day: "DREAM IT; DO IT"
- **World Brain Day (July 22):** The 12th World Brain Day 2025, a global campaign devoted to promoting brain health for all ages. Our vision for WBD2025 is to work collaboratively with UN ECOSOC and

the WHO Brain Health Unit, making this initiative a historic milestone in establishing brain health as a universally recognized priority.

- ✓ The theme of World Brain Day: Brain Health for All Ages

- **World Mangrove Day (July 26):** Mangroves are unique ecosystems between land and sea. They support biodiversity, protect coastal communities, enhance food security, and act as natural defenses against storms and erosion. Their soils are also powerful carbon sinks.
- **World Lung Cancer Day (August 1):** Recognized globally to promote awareness regarding lung cancer screening and research. The day also aims to educate individuals about the risk factors for lung cancer, including smoking, air pollution and exposure to harmful substances.

Q 70. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Ministry of Culture officially launched the 'Gyan Bharatam Mission' (first announced in the Union Budget 2025–26) as a landmark national movement to survey, conserve, digitize, and disseminate India's estimated 10 million ancient manuscripts.
✓ To inaugurate this initiative, the Ministry organized the first-ever Gyan Bharatam International Conference on 'Reclaiming India's Knowledge Legacy Through Manuscript Heritage' in September 2025 at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The National Digital Repository (NDR) established under the Gyan Bharatam Mission is not intended for restricted or purely domestic academic use. The official mandate of the NDR is to create a secure, globally accessible digital archive.
✓ It utilizes advanced AI-driven translation, tagging, and cataloguing tools specifically to democratize access and share India's ancient civilizational knowledge (Bharatiya Jnana Parampara) with researchers, scholars, and the public worldwide.

Q 71. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** As per the Global Forest Resources Assessment 2025 released by the Food and Agriculture Organization, India has improved its ranking from 10th to 9th position globally in

terms of total forest area. This reflects the country's continued efforts in afforestation, plantation forestry, and sustainable forest management.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** India has maintained its 3rd position globally in net annual increase in forest area. This indicates that India is among the leading countries contributing positively to forest expansion, largely due to policies promoting afforestation, agroforestry, and conservation initiatives.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** India's forests play a crucial role in climate change mitigation. Being ranked 5th among global carbon sinks, Indian forests absorb approximately 150 million tonnes of CO₂ annually, highlighting their importance in reducing greenhouse gas concentrations and supporting India's climate commitments.

Q 72. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Integrated Cold Chain and Value Addition Infrastructure (ICCVAI) is a Central Sector Scheme that was restructured under the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Sampada Yojana (PMKSY). Its primary objective is to build a seamless cold chain from the farm gate to the retail outlet in order to significantly reduce post-harvest losses of perishable commodities (such as horticulture, dairy, meat, and marine products).
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Financial assistance is not provided uniformly across all regions. The scheme provides grants or subsidies covering 35% of the eligible project cost in general areas. The 50% subsidy rate is strictly reserved for difficult areas, as well as for proposals originating from SC/ST groups, Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs), and Self-Help Groups (SHGs).

Q 73. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** India indeed ranks 3rd globally in terms of pharmaceutical production by volume (and 14th by value). The primary reasons for this massive volume include India's global dominance in manufacturing generic medicines (accounting for roughly 20% of the global generic supply), a highly skilled workforce, significantly lower production costs compared to Western nations, and substantial domestic demand.
- **Reason (R) is true:** A very significant portion of India's pharmaceutical exports goes to highly

regulated markets like the United States (the largest single destination) and the European Union. India has the highest number of US-FDA-compliant plants outside of the United States.

- **Why (R) does not explain (A):** While (R) is a factual statement highlighting the quality and global trust in Indian pharmaceuticals, it is not the primary cause of the sheer volume of production mentioned in (A). The 3rd rank in volume is driven by mass generic manufacturing and cost-effectiveness for both domestic and global (regulated and unregulated) markets, rather than solely by exports to the US and Europe.

Q 74. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The BioE3 Policy was officially approved by the Union Cabinet (chaired by the Prime Minister) to foster high-performance biomanufacturing in India. It aims to accelerate the transition from chemical-based industries to more sustainable, bio-based economic models.
- **Key Pillars (The 3 'E's):**
 - ✓ **Economy:** Driving innovation and scaling up bio-manufacturing to contribute significantly to India's bioeconomy.
 - ✓ **Environment:** Promoting green growth, circular bioeconomy models, and reducing the carbon footprint by developing bio-based chemicals, smart proteins, and climate-resilient agriculture.
 - ✓ **Employment:** Generating extensive employment opportunities by establishing Biomanufacturing and Bio-AI hubs across the country, which will require a highly skilled workforce and support biomanufacturing startups.

Q 75. Ans. B

Explanation:

- India's first nanostructured metallic thermal interface hub was established at the Foundation for Innovators in Science and Technology (FIST) center at IIT Patna, in collaboration with Markets World.
- This state-of-the-art hub was launched to serve as a major center for research and manufacturing in the field of advanced electronic materials and thermal management technologies. It aims to address critical technical challenges in sectors like electronics, telecommunications, and semiconductors, positioning Bihar as a new deep-tech and advanced manufacturing hub

Q 76. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Kanwar Lake, also known as Kabartal, is situated in the Begusarai district of Bihar and holds the distinction of being the first Ramsar site of the state, designated in November 2020. It is a residual oxbow lake formed due to the meandering of the Burhi Gandak River, a tributary of the Ganga, and is part of the Indo-Gangetic plains. Covering around 6,000 hectares, it is considered the largest freshwater wetland in Asia, highlighting its ecological and geographical significance.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Kanwar Lake is not a glacial lake and is not located in the Himalayan region. Instead, it is an oxbow lake in the plains of Bihar. Moreover, it is an important site along the Central Asian Flyway, serving as a crucial stopover and wintering ground for over 58 species of migratory waterfowl, including species like the Siberian Crane, Bar-headed Goose, and Painted Stork. The lake also supports rich biodiversity, including more than 50 species of fish, making it ecologically very important.

Q 77. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- The draft Seeds Bill, 2025, explicitly proposes to replace two specific long-standing laws to align the sector with contemporary agricultural needs:
 - ✓ The Seeds Act, 1966
 - ✓ The Seeds (Control) Order, 1983
- It aims to regulate the:
 - ✓ quality of seeds and planting materials available in the market
 - ✓ ensure farmers' access to high-quality seeds at affordable prices
 - ✓ curb the sale of counterfeit and poor-quality seeds
 - ✓ protect farmers from crop losses

Q 78. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- India's employability has risen to 56.35% in 2026, marking a steady rise in the country's readiness for a skilled and digitally empowered global workforce.
- It highlights a sharp increase in India's employable talent from 54.81% in 2025 to 56.35% in 2026.
- The theme for this year was "The Future of Work: Gig Workforce, Freelancing, AI-Supplemented Workforce, Remote Work and Entrepreneurship

- India now commands 16% of the global AI talent pool, projected to reach 1.25 million professionals by 2027.
- Top employable states: Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Karnataka lead in employability for 2026.

Q 79. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- 'Willow' is a quantum processor developed by Google as part of its Quantum AI research efforts. It represents a major advancement in the field of quantum computing, particularly in demonstrating verifiable quantum advantage.
- Quantum advantage refers to a situation where a quantum computer performs a specific task faster or more efficiently than the best possible classical computers. In the case of Willow, it has demonstrated this capability experimentally, marking a key milestone toward real-world applications of quantum technologies.

Q 80. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Similar to traditional antiferromagnets, altermagnets exhibit no net macroscopic magnetization. Their adjacent magnetic moments (spins) alternate in direction and perfectly cancel each other out externally, meaning they do not generate stray magnetic fields.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** This is the defining breakthrough of altermagnets. Despite having absolutely zero net magnetization, they exhibit strongly spin-split electronic bands in momentum space. Historically, such spin polarization was thought to be exclusive to ferromagnets. Altermagnets combine the zero net magnetization of antiferromagnets with the spin-polarization characteristics of ferromagnets.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The unique properties of altermagnets arise from their specific crystal symmetries. In an altermagnet, the sublattices with opposite spins are not just translated (as in antiferromagnets) but are connected by specific spatial rotations or reflections. This unique symmetry coupling between real space (the crystal lattice) and momentum space is what generates the alternating spin-polarized bands (often referred to as d-wave or g-wave magnetism).
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** Altermagnets do not operate on slow millisecond time scales. Like antiferromagnets, they possess ultra-fast,

high-frequency spin dynamics, typically operating in the terahertz (THz) range (picosecond time scales). This ultra-fast switching capability is one of the primary reasons they are highly sought after for next-generation spintronics and high-speed memory devices.

Q 81. Ans. D

Explanation:

- India observed International Snow Leopard Day with a unique initiative called ‘#23for23’, encouraging citizens to engage in physical activity for 23 minutes to promote awareness about the conservation of snow leopards and their fragile habitats.
- Meanwhile, the country’s first-ever Snow Leopard Census recorded 718 individuals across the Indian Himalayas, with Ladakh accounting for the highest number at 477 snow leopards, highlighting its significance as a key habitat for the species.
- **About Snow Leopard**
 - ✓ Keystone and indicator species of high-altitude ecosystems; flagship species of the Himalayas
 - ✓ Known as the “Ghost of the Mountains”
 - ✓ 7th largest cat, found in alpine and subalpine regions of Central and South Asia
 - ✓ In India: mainly in Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, and Uttarakhand
 - ✓ Status: Vulnerable (IUCN), Appendix I (CITES), Schedule I (Wildlife Protection Act, 1972)

Q 82. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** The primary objective of the Aditya-L1 mission is indeed to study the upper atmospheric dynamics of the Sun (chromosphere and corona). It carries seven indigenous payloads, including the Visible Emission Line Coronagraph (VELC) to study Coronal Mass Ejections (CMEs) and the solar corona, as well as an advanced Magnetometer (MAG) to measure the interplanetary magnetic field at the L1 point.
- **Reason (R) is false:** The factual error in this statement lies in the distance. The Lagrange point 1 (L1) is located approximately 1.5 million km from the Earth (directed towards the Sun), not 1.5 million km from the Sun. The total distance between the Earth and the Sun is about 150 million km, meaning Aditya-L1 is placed at a distance of barely 1% of the total Earth-Sun distance.

Q 83. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Marine Fisheries Census (MFC) 2025 represents a historic paradigm shift as India’s first fully digitized and geo-referenced fisheries census. Transitioning entirely from conventional paper-based methods, it utilizes a suite of custom-built, multilingual Android applications (the VyAS app ecosystem—including VyAS-NAV, VyAS-BHARAT, and VyAS-SUTRA) to capture real-time, geo-referenced data directly from the field.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The institutional roles and funding sources are incorrectly swapped in this statement. The census is fully funded by the Department of Fisheries, Government of India (under the overarching Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana). The ICAR-CMFRI serves as the primary nodal agency responsible for its execution, while the Fishery Survey of India (FSI) acts as the operational partner.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** A major feature of this 5th edition of the census is its expanded scope to capture granular socio-economic data. For the first time, it meticulously tracks indicators such as household income, insurance, liabilities, pandemic-related impacts, and explicitly measures the reach of government welfare schemes, including the PM-MKSSY (Pradhan Mantri Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-Yojana).

Q 84. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Andhra Pradesh has planned to develop the Great Green Wall to protect its coastline, enhance biodiversity, and safeguard three million residents from cyclones and erosion.
- Andhra Pradesh has been assessed as the fourth most affected State in India in coastal erosion. 32% of the coastline is actively eroding, and the shorelines of the Krishna and Godavari estuaries are critically vulnerable.
- The Great Green Wall
 - ✓ The project plans to plant wind- and salt-tolerant trees along the coastline to form a 5-kilometrewide “living ecological shield” across 1,053 kilometres by 2030.
 - ✓ It aims to safeguard lives, protect property, and strengthen the state’s climate resilience.

Q 85. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Bamuni Garrison, Assam**
 - ✓ Home to the Lachit Borphukan Military Station, this is the Army's first sizeable formation positioned close to the Bangladesh boundary in Assam.
 - ✓ Its role is to monitor cross-border activity, improve operational visibility, and support ground forces in the lower Assam region.
- **Kishanganj Military Base, Bihar**
 - ✓ Located close to the West Bengal–Assam transit route, this base strengthens the Indian Army's ability to move troops swiftly towards the Siliguri Corridor.
 - ✓ It also acts as a logistical node, ensuring that reinforcements or supplies can reach the area without delay.
- **Chopra Base, West Bengal**
 - ✓ It is situated in northern West Bengal, the Chopra installation has been built to improve quick-reaction capability.
 - ✓ It integrates surveillance inputs, intelligence feeds, and field operations, helping the military respond rapidly to emerging threats or crises in the region.

Q 86. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The theme for the fourth edition of India Maritime Week (IMW) 2025, which was inaugurated in Mumbai, was explicitly declared as "Uniting Oceans, One Maritime Vision."
- This theme was chosen to reflect the event's core goal of connecting global partners from over 85 nations through shared maritime aspirations, while also reaffirming India's foundational ethos of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam (the world is one family).

Q 87. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The 22nd ASEAN–India Summit (2025) was held in Kuala Lumpur, under the chairmanship of Malaysia. The summit aimed to further strengthen India–ASEAN cooperation, particularly in the area of maritime security.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi participated virtually, marking his 12th participation in the summit. A key highlight was the participation of Timor-Leste as the 11th ASEAN member, attending the summit for the first time as a full member.

Q 88. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Kochi recently hosted the first biennial BIMSTEC–India Marine Research Network (BIMReN) Conference, marking an important step in strengthening regional cooperation in marine science and ocean research among BIMSTEC countries.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Oman has been elected to the International Coordinating Council of UNESCO's Man and the Biosphere (MAB) Programme for the 2025–2029 term. This reflects its growing engagement in global environmental conservation and sustainable development initiatives under the UNESCO framework.

Q 89. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** the 6th National Water Awards 2024, announced by the Ministry of Jal Shakti, Maharashtra secured the first position in the Best State category for its performance in water conservation and management initiatives. It was followed by Gujarat in second place and Haryana in third place, reflecting strong inter-state competition in water governance.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Navi Municipal Corporation in Maharashtra was awarded the top rank in the Best Urban Local Body (ULB) category for its effective implementation of water conservation measures, efficient urban water management practices, and innovative governance. Bhavnagar Municipal Corporation of Gujarat secured the second position.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Shri Kishore Jaiswal from Bihar was honoured with the first prize in the Best Individual category, recognising his significant contributions and excellence in the field of water resource management. Dubbiganipalli (Andhra Pradesh) and Payam (Kerala) shared the top rank in the Best Village Panchayat category.

Q 90. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- **Prof. Jayant Vishnu Narlikar (Physics):** He was posthumously honored with the Vigyan Ratna, the highest category of the award, for his lifetime achievements and monumental contributions to astrophysics and cosmology (including the Hoyle–Narlikar theory).

- **Dr. Yusuf Mohammad Seikh (Atomic Energy):** A scientist at the Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC), he was conferred the Vigyan Shri award for his distinguished contributions to the field of Atomic Energy.
- **Dr. S Venkata Mohan (Environmental Science):** The Chief Scientist at CSIR-Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT), he was awarded the Vigyan Shri for his pioneering research in environmental biotechnology, waste-to-wealth processes, and clean energy transitions.
- **Shri Ankur Garg (Space Science and Technology):** A scientist at ISRO's Space Applications Centre (SAC), he received the Vigyan Yuva - Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar Award (which recognizes young scientists under 45) for his exceptional contributions to satellite data processing, Earth observation, and AI in remote sensing.

Q 91. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Sanjay Kumar Hansda (Executive Director, RBI):** He was appointed as the Executive Director of the Reserve Bank of India to oversee the Department of Economic and Policy Research after returning from his deputation as Senior Advisor at the International Monetary Fund (IMF).
- **Justice Surya Kant (53rd CJI):** In the established seniority succession of the Supreme Court of India, Justice Surya Kant is slated to serve as the 53rd Chief Justice of India
- **Vishvajit Sahay (Controller General of Defence Accounts):** He held the apex position of Controller General of Defence Accounts (CGDA) before recently being elevated to assume charge as Secretary (Defence Finance)
- **Raj Kumar Arora (Financial Advisor of Defence Services):** he officially assumed the critical role of Financial Advisor (Defence Services) moving over from his previous role as Special CGDA.

Q 92. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Maldives has become the first country in the world to impose a generational smoking ban, barring anyone born after Jan. 1, 2007, from ever smoking, purchasing or using tobacco.
- The ban applies to all forms of tobacco, and retailers are required to verify age prior to sale," the health ministry said Saturday as the ban came into effect.

Q 93. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Abhinav Bindra selected as torchbearer for Milano Cortina 2026 Winter Olympics
- The Olympic gold medal-winning Indian shooter also ran with the Olympic flame during the Paris 2024 Olympics Torch Relay.

Q 94. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** INS Ikshak was officially commissioned into the Indian Navy during a ceremonial event held at Naval Base, Kochi on November 6, 2025, presided over by the Chief of the Naval Staff.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The vessel is an indigenously built Survey Vessel designed to undertake full-scale coastal and deep-water hydrographic and oceanographic surveys of ports, harbours, and navigational channels. It was built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) Ltd., Kolkata, and features over 80% indigenous content, reflecting the Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** INS Ikshak is indeed the third vessel of the Survey Vessel Large (SVL) class (following INS Sandhayak and INS Nirdeshak). It holds the distinct designation of being the first SVL to be based at the Southern Naval Command. Additionally, it is the first vessel in this class designed with dedicated accommodation for women officers and sailors

Q 95. Ans. C

Explanation:

- India's first study on 'teal carbon' was conducted at the Keoladeo National Park (KNP) in Bharatpur district of Rajasthan. The study highlights the growing importance of wetlands in climate change mitigation and adaptation strategies.
- Teal carbon is a relatively new concept in environmental science. It refers to the organic carbon stored in inland freshwater wetlands, including carbon present in vegetation, soils, microbial biomass, and dissolved or particulate organic matter. Unlike blue carbon (coastal ecosystems like mangroves and seagrasses), teal carbon focuses on non-tidal freshwater wetland ecosystems.

Q 96. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** UiWIN is a institutional investment-facilitation platform. It was launched by

the Housing and Urban Development Corporation Ltd. (HUDCO) under the guidance of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA). It acts as a single-window mechanism to assist cities and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) in identifying viable infrastructure projects and transitioning them from concept to investment-ready proposals.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** UiWIN is not designed to isolate projects from external funding; its primary mandate is the exact opposite. It serves to help ULBs build “bankable” project pipelines specifically to attract and mobilize external investments. This includes facilitating access to capital markets (like municipal bonds), structuring Public-Private Partnership (PPP) projects, and securing long-tenor, competitive financing from multilateral and bilateral institutions such as the World Bank, Asian Development Bank (ADB), and the International Finance Corporation (IFC).

Q 97. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The ‘Aabhar Online Store’ has been launched by Indian Railways and is hosted on the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) platform. It is an initiative aimed at strengthening the vision of “Vocal for Local” by promoting indigenous products and artisans.
- The platform provides a dedicated space for showcasing and selling gift items made by rural and tribal artisans, handloom weavers, and local producers. It also supports products falling under key government initiatives such as One District One Product (ODOP) and Geographical Indication (GI) tagged goods, thereby enhancing their market visibility.

Q 98. Ans. B

Explanation:

- NexCAR19 is India’s first indigenously developed Chimeric Antigen Receptor (CAR) T-cell therapy.
- **Application:** It is specifically designed for the treatment of patients with relapsed or refractory B-cell lymphomas and leukemia, which are types of blood cancers.
- **Development:** It was developed collaboratively by ImmunoACT (a company incubated at the Indian Institute of Technology Bombay) and the Tata Memorial Hospital.
- Its indigenous development significantly reduces the cost of this highly advanced life-saving

treatment compared to importing similar therapies from abroad. It received approval from India’s drug regulator, the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO), in late 2023.

Q 99. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Sir Creek is a 96-km long tidal estuary located in the marshy Rann of Kutch region, forming the boundary area between Gujarat (India) and Sindh province (Pakistan). The dispute over Sir Creek is one of the long-standing India–Pakistan issues, first emerging in 1914 due to contradictory interpretations of a British-era resolution passed by the Bombay government.
- Historically, the area was earlier known as Ban Ganga, but it was renamed Sir Creek during British rule after a British administrative official. The dispute has two main dimensions: territorial ownership of the creek itself and its impact on maritime boundary delimitation, which further affects Exclusive Economic Zones (EEZ) and resource rights in the Arabian Sea.

Q 100. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Kanwar Lake (Kabartal):** Situated in Begusarai district, this is Asia’s largest freshwater oxbow lake. It was officially declared Bihar’s first Ramsar site in 2020 and serves as a vital wintering habitat for migratory birds traversing the Central Asian Flyway.
- **Nagi Bird Sanctuary:** Located in Jamui district. This man-made reservoir, along with the nearby Nakti Bird Sanctuary, was officially recognized as a Ramsar site in 2024 for its significant ecological role in supporting diverse migratory waterfowl.
- **Gokul Reservoir (Gokul Jalashay):** Located in Buxar district. It is an important wetland area supporting local biodiversity and agricultural ecosystems in the region.
- **Udaipur Lake:** Situated in West Champaran district, this natural oxbow lake was formed by the meandering of the Gandak River. It sits adjacent to the Udaipur Wildlife Sanctuary.

Q 101. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The solar power plant is being constructed in the Suryagarha block of Lakhisarai district. This project is a major component of

Bihar's strategy to transition toward green energy and reduce its carbon footprint.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The facility features a Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) to ensure grid stability and provide uninterrupted power for 4 to 5 hours during peak demand or low sunlight periods. The project is being executed in two phases. Phase I integrates a 254 megawatt-hour (MWh) storage system, and Phase II integrates a 241 MWh storage system. Upon the targeted completion of the entire project by January 2027, the total planned battery storage capacity will stand at 495 MWh, supporting a total solar generation capacity of 301 MW.

Q 102. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Sahyog Portal was officially launched by the Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) and is operated by the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C). Its primary function is to integrate all authorized national agencies and digital intermediaries onto a single platform to swiftly tackle unlawful online content and promote a safer cyberspace.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Section 79 provides intermediaries with "safe harbour" protection, shielding them from legal liability for user-generated content. The Sahyog portal was introduced to automate and streamline the process of issuing official takedown notices. Under Section 79(3)(b), intermediaries lose their safe harbour immunity if they fail to promptly remove the unlawful content after receiving these official notices through the platform.

Q 103. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Union Cabinet approved the National Green Hydrogen Mission in 2023, with an outlay of ₹ 19,744 crore. Under the National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM), the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW) has specifically identified three major ports to be developed as Green Hydrogen Hubs. The goal of this initiative is to build the necessary infrastructure for the generation, storage, handling, bunkering, and export of green hydrogen and its derivatives (like green ammonia).
- The three officially recognized ports are:
 - ✓ Deendayal Port Authority (Kandla, Gujarat)
 - ✓ V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority (Tuticorin, Tamil Nadu)
 - ✓ Paradip Port Authority (Odisha)

Q 104. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Oil India Limited (OIL) has definitively established the presence of natural gas reserves in the **Andaman Sea offshore basin**. The significant hydrocarbon find was encountered at the **Sri Vijayapuram-2** exploratory well, located approximately 17 kilometers off the eastern coast of the Andaman Islands.

Q 105. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The Philippines recently launched Southeast Asia's first Coral Larvae Cryobank, a pioneering facility established by the University of the Philippines Marine Science Institute (UP MSI).
- **Purpose:** The facility acts as a "genetic seed vault" for corals. Its primary goal is to preserve coral genetic diversity and safeguard reef ecosystems against the escalating threats of climate change, ocean warming, and mass coral bleaching.

Q 106. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Geological Heritage of St. Mary's Island Cluster, Karnataka:** Known for its rare columnar basaltic rock formations, this island cluster dates back to the Late Cretaceous period, offering a geological snapshot from around 85 million years ago.
- **Meghalayan Age Caves, Meghalaya:** The stunning cave systems of Meghalaya, particularly the Mawmluh Cave, serve as the global reference point for the Meghalayan Age in the Holocene Epoch, reflecting significant climate and geological transitions.
- **Natural Heritage of Tirumala Hills, Andhra Pradesh:** Featuring the Eparchaeon Unconformity and the iconic Silathoranam (Natural Arch), this site holds immense geological significance, representing over 1.5 billion years of Earth's history.
- **Varkala Cliffs, Kerala:** The scenic cliffs along Kerala's coastline expose the Warkalli Formation of the Mio-Pliocene age, along with natural springs and striking erosional landforms, offering both scientific and touristic value.

Other Natural Heritage Sites

- **Naga Hill Ophiolite, Nagaland:** A rare exposure of ophiolite rocks, these hills represent oceanic crust uplifted onto continental plates—offering deep insights into tectonic processes and mid-ocean ridge dynamics.

- **Deccan Traps at Panchgani and Mahabaleshwar, Maharashtra :** Home to some of the best-preserved and studied lava flows in the world, these sites form part of the massive Deccan Traps and are located within the Koyna Wildlife Sanctuary—already a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
- **Erra Matti Dibbalu (Red Sand Hills), Andhra Pradesh:** These visually striking red sand formations near Visakhapatnam showcase unique paleo-climatic and coastal geomorphological features that reveal Earth's climatic history and dynamic evolution.

Q 107. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The 2025 Nobel Prize in Physics has been awarded to John Clarke, Michel H. Devoret, Santa Barbara, and John M. Martinis, Santa Barbara, for their groundbreaking “discovery of macroscopic quantum mechanical tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit.
- Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson and Omar Yaghi are awarded the Nobel Prize in Chemistry 2025. They have developed a new form of molecular architecture. In their constructions, metal ions function as cornerstones that are linked by long organic (carbon-based) molecules.
- Mary E. Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell and Shimon Sakaguchi are awarded the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine 2025 for their groundbreaking discoveries concerning peripheral immune tolerance that prevents the immune system from harming the body.
- The Nobel Peace Prize 2025 was awarded to Maria Corina Machado “for her tireless work promoting democratic rights for the people of Venezuela and for her struggle to achieve a just and peaceful transition from dictatorship to democracy”.

Q 108. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Sanae Takaichi made history when she was elected as the first female President of the ruling Liberal Democratic Party (LDP) and subsequently took office as the first female Prime Minister of Japan. She succeeded Shigeru Ishiba, becoming the 104th Prime Minister of the country.

Q 109. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Pavan Kumar Bhimappa Bajanthri:** He serves as

the 46th Chief Justice of the Patna High Court. Keeping track of high-level judicial appointments in the state is a key aspect of preparing for the state-specific sections of the examination.

- **Vandana Gupta:** She assumed the apex role of Controller General of Communication Accounts (CGCA) in September 2025, overseeing national telecommunication finance and audits.
- **R. Venkataramani:** He is a distinguished senior advocate of the Supreme Court who currently holds the constitutional post of the Attorney General of India, the chief legal advisor to the Government of India.
- **Shirish Chandra Murmu:** Appointed as an Executive Director, he officially assumed office as the Deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) in October 2025 for a three-year tenure.

Q 110. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Why the Constitution Matters :** Former Chief Justice of India D.Y. Chandrachud penned this book to explore the importance of the Constitution in everyday life, fundamental rights, and the role of landmark judgments in safeguarding democracy.
- **Mother Mary Comes to Me** is written by Arundhati Roy, known for her literary and socio-political works. This is a deeply moving memoir by the acclaimed author, tracing her complex and intimate relationship with her mother, Mary Roy, and how it shaped her as a writer.
- **Different But No Less** is authored by Anupam Kher, the *Unscripted Story Behind the Making of Tanvi the Great*, marking the veteran actor's fourth book which delves into his unscripted personal and professional experiences.
- **Same Heart, Same World** is written by Dr. Maneesha V. Ramesh. This prominent book was recently officially released by the Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting, Dr. L Murugan.

Q 111. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Digitised Retrieval Application for Versatile Yardstick of Ayush (DRAVYA) is an ambitious initiative of the Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS) aims to catalogue information on 100 key medicinal substances, with data continuously updated through a dedicated entry software to ensure precision and authenticity.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Ministry of Ayush unveiled the portal during the recently held 10th Ayurveda Day event at Goa. The platform also features QR code integration, enabling standardised information display in medicinal plant gardens and drug repositories nationwide. It serves as a comprehensive, open-access database that dynamically consolidates data from classical Ayurvedic texts and standard online research platforms.

Q 112. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The inaugural edition of the Tri Services Academia Technology Symposium (T-SATS) commenced today at the Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi, synergising the Services-Academia R&D ecosystem for development of niche and futuristic technologies tailored for the Indian Armed Forces. The symposium was inaugurated by Chief of Defence Staff (CDS), General Anil Chauhan.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The official theme of the maiden symposium was “Vivek va Anusandhan se Vijay” (Victory through Wisdom and Research). The symposium, a first of its kind, is a significant step towards fostering deeper integration between academic research capabilities and defence technology requirements.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Symposium also inaugurated a Technology Exhibition showcasing 43 selected innovative exhibits by academia. These innovations were evaluated by Subject Matter Experts from various technology domains of the three Services for their potential military applications. Projects showing promise will be considered for R&D collaboration and funding support in future.

Q 113. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully conducted the preliminary automotive trials of the Indian light Tank, Zorawar, a highly versatile platform capable of deployment in high-altitude areas.
- During the field trials conducted in the desert terrain, the Light Tank demonstrated exceptional performance, efficiently meeting all the intended objectives. In the initial phase, the tank's firing performance was rigorously evaluated and it achieved the required accuracy on designated targets.

Q 114. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Lecanemab (marketed under the brand name Leqembi) is scientifically classified as a monoclonal antibody. It represents a significant advancement in neurological therapeutics and is highly relevant for science and technology segments of competitive examinations.
- **Monoclonal antibody:** These are laboratory-produced molecules engineered to serve as substitute antibodies that can restore, enhance, or mimic the immune system's attack on target cells.

Q 115. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Wildlife Institute of India, under the aegis of Project Elephant, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, has conducted the country's first DNA-based population estimation of Asian elephants as part of the All India Synchronized Elephant Estimation-2023. Using non-invasive genetic sampling and spatial capture-recapture (SECR) modelling, the study provides a scientifically robust estimate of elephant numbers across India's major elephant landscapes.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Karnataka records the highest elephant population at 6,013 – both within the Ghats landscape and nationally. In the Ghats it was followed by Tamil Nadu and Kerala with around 3,136 and 2,785 elephants respectively.

Q 116. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Samudra Shakti:** This is a bilateral maritime exercise between the Indian Navy and the Indonesian Navy aimed at enhancing interoperability, mutual understanding, and maritime cooperation in the region.
- **AUSTRALIND:** This is a joint military exercise between the Indian Armed Forces and the Australian Army to promote military ties and share best practices in peacekeeping operations.
- **IN-ROKN :** This acronym stands for the Indian Navy - Republic of Korea Navy bilateral maritime exercise, focusing on maritime security and defense cooperation.
- **JAIMEX:** The Japan-India Maritime Exercise is an annual bilateral naval training event conducted by the Indian Navy and the Japan Maritime Self-Defense Force (JMSDF).

Q 117. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Gram Panchayats were today conferred with the National Awards for e-Governance (NAeG) 2025 under a newly instituted category dedicated to grassroots-level initiatives in digital service delivery. The Awards were conferred during the 28th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG) in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Gram Panchayats were awarded under the newly introduced category, “Grassroots-level initiatives in Gram Panchayats for deepening service delivery” :
 - ✓ **Gold Award:** Rohini Gram Panchayat, Dhule District, Maharashtra
 - ✓ **Silver Award:** West Majlishpur Gram Panchayat, West Tripura District, Tripura
 - ✓ **Jury Award:** Palsana Gram Panchayat, Surat District, Gujarat
 - ✓ **Jury Award:** Suakati Gram Panchayat, Kendujhar District, Odisha
- Rohini Gram Panchayat, Maharashtra has become the first Gram Panchayat in the State to adopt a fully paperless e-Office system, offering 1,027 online services and ensuring 100% household digital literacy.

Q 118. Ans. B

Explanation:

- *Apterichtus kanniyakumari* is a newly discovered marine species of finless snake eel belonging to the family Ophichthidae.
- The species belonging to the genus *Apterichtus* and discovered off the Colachel coast has been named after Kanniyakumari to honour the district's cultural, linguistic, historical and geographical significance

Q 119. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The “Promise to Children” campaign was jointly launched by the ICC and UNICEF during the ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2025 (hosted by India and Sri Lanka). It aims to leverage the global platform of cricket to advocate for children's rights, including access to quality education, healthcare, nutrition, sanitation, and protection from violence.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** UNICEF India National Ambassador Ayushmann Khurrana, alongside

Indian women's cricket team vice-captain Smriti Mandhana, were appointed as the prominent faces/ambassadors to lead and support this digital campaign.

Q 120. Ans. B

Explanation:

- NAKSHA stands for the National geospatial Knowledge-based land Survey of urban Habitations. It is a major city survey initiative launched under the Digital India Land Records Modernization Programme (DILRMP).
- The programme aims to modernize, digitize, and standardize urban land records. It utilizes cutting-edge geospatial technologies—such as high-resolution drone mapping, LiDAR sensors, Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) surveys, and Web-GIS platforms—to create accurate, integrated 2D and 3D digital maps of urban land parcels.

Q 121. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Prime Minister Internship Scheme provides a monthly financial assistance (stipend) of ₹9,000 to the interns. This amount is jointly funded by the Government of India provides ₹8,100 through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT), and the host company contributes the remaining ₹900 from its Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) funds. Additionally, the government provides a one-time grant of ₹6,000 for incidentals upon joining.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The candidate's age should be between 21 to 24 years (as on the last date for submission of the application). The candidate should not be full-time employed. The core objective is to provide a 12-month, full-time real-world corporate exposure to unemployed youth to enhance their employability. Candidates enrolled in online or distance learning programs, however, remain eligible.

Q 122. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** The Mhaje Ghar Yojana (My House Scheme) grants legal ownership rights (Sanads) to long-term residents who have resided for decades in homes built on government and comunidade (community) lands.
- **Reason (R) is true:** Launched by the Government of Goa, the core objective of the scheme is to

regularize unauthorized or illegally built dwellings. It is implemented under various frameworks, including the Goa Land Revenue Code and the Goa Regularisation of Unauthorized Constructions Act, to eliminate the fear of eviction and provide long-term housing security.

- **Conclusion:** (R) provides the correct explanation for (A). The scheme grants property ownership rights (Assertion) because the state government aims to regularize these historic unauthorized constructions to establish housing security and legal empowerment for the residents

Q 123. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **World Alzheimer's Day - 21 September 2025**
 - ✓ The theme is "Ask About Dementia. Ask About Alzheimer"
 - ✓ World Alzheimer's Day 2024 Theme - Time to act on dementia, Time to act on Alzheimer's
- **World Tourism Day is observed every year on 27th September**
 - ✓ The theme for this year is 'Tourism and Sustainable Transformation',
 - ✓ The day commemorates the adoption of the United Nations World Tourism Organisation statutes in 1970.
 - ✓ It was celebrated for the first time in the year 1980.
- **On 6 October 2025, the Global Observance of World Habitat Day**
 - ✓ 2025 Theme: Urban crisis response
 - ✓ The theme focuses on addressing multiple crises affecting urban areas - including climate and conflicts - that are contributing to inequality, and promotes existing tools and approaches to effective crisis response
- **International Day of Older Persons observed 1 October every year**
 - ✓ Theme, 'Ageing with Dignity: The Importance of Strengthening Care and Support Systems for Older Persons Worldwide'

Q 124. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Viksit Bharat Buildathon 2025 is a nationwide initiative organised by the Department of School Education & Literacy (DoSEL), Ministry of Education, in collaboration with the Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), NITI Aayog, and the All India Council for Technical

Education (AICTE). It was launched to foster a culture of innovation and problem-solving at the grassroots level.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** This largest-ever school hackathon aims to strengthen the culture of innovation at the school level by encouraging students to ideate or build prototypes on four themes: Atmanirbhar Bharat, Swadeshi, Vocal for Local, and Samridh Bharat. The Buildathon targets school students from Classes 6 to 12 across India. It is not "exclusive" to engineering or technical college students.

Q 125. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is True:** Fentanyl is a potent synthetic opioid analgesic. It was first synthesized in 1960 and was specifically designed for medical use—primarily for treating severe pain, such as that associated with advanced cancer or post-surgical recovery. It works by binding to the body's opioid receptors, which are found in areas of the central nervous system (the brain and spinal cord) that control pain and emotions. It is estimated to be 50 to 100 times more potent than morphine.
- **Reason (R) is False:** Far from being removed from watchlists, Fentanyl is currently one of the most monitored substances globally. The United States and international bodies (like the UN Office on Drugs and Crime) have increased scrutiny due to a devastating "opioid crisis" fueled by illegal trade and synthetic manufacturing.

Q 126. Ans. C

Explanation:

- India is set to launch its inaugural cheetah safari at Kuno National Park, offering visitors a unique chance to witness the fastest land animal. This landmark initiative, stemming from a successful reintroduction project, aims to boost tourism while significantly contributing to wildlife conservation efforts and habitat management.

Q 127. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Index of Economic Freedom is published annually by The Heritage Foundation, a prominent Washington-based think tank, in collaboration with The Wall Street Journal.
 - ✓ It highlights the fragility of the global economy, as it remains "mostly unfree" as a whole, even

though the global average economic freedom score has increased by 1.1 points to 59.7 from last year's 58.6.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** India ranks at 128 (and 26th regionally) with a score of 53.0 in 2025. It still falls under the “mostly unfree” economic freedom. India is struggling with fiscal health, scoring a very low 6.2, along with investment freedom and financial freedom, both scoring 40 and government integrity at 37.6.

- Top ranker countries

1	Singapore	84.1	Free
2	Switzerland	83.7	Free
3	Ireland	83.1	Free

Q 128. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The National Annual Report and Index on Women's Safety (NARI) 2025 was not published by NITI Aayog. It was released by the National Commission for Women (NCW). The report was prepared by Pvalue Analytics and published by the Group of Intellectuals and Academicians (GIA) to capture women's lived experiences and perceptions of safety beyond official crime statistics.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** According to the NARI 2025 report, Kohima (Nagaland) and Visakhapatnam (Andhra Pradesh), along with Bhubaneswar (Odisha), topped the index and emerged as the safest cities for women. These cities were recognized for stronger gender equity, civic participation, women-friendly infrastructure, and reliable policing. In contrast, cities like Patna, Jaipur, Faridabad, Delhi, and Ranchi ranked at the bottom of the safety index.

Q 129. Ans. B

Explanation:

- PRATUSH (Probing Reionization of the Universe using Signal from Hydrogen) is an ambitious space-based radio telescope project conceptualized by the Raman Research Institute (RRI) in collaboration with the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO).
- The mission's main objective is to detect the extremely faint radio signals (specifically the 21-cm line) emitted by neutral hydrogen atoms from the “Cosmic Dawn.” This is the era when the universe's first stars and galaxies began to form, bringing an end to the cosmological “Dark Ages.”

Q 130. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Albania appointed an AI system to a cabinet-level position—a world-first. Called Diella (Albanian for “sun”), the system was declared “Minister of State for Artificial Intelligence,” and tasked by Albania's Prime Minister with addressing corruption in government contracting.
- The appointment is also being viewed in the context of Albania's ambition to join the European Union by 2030, for which, cracking down on corruption is a vital condition.

Q 131. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in April 2023 in Mysuru, Karnataka, to commemorate the 50th anniversary of the landmark ‘Project Tiger’.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The core objective of the alliance is to halt the decline and secure the future of the world's seven major big cats: Tiger, Lion, Leopard, Snow Leopard, Cheetah, Jaguar, and Puma.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The global headquarters of the IBCA is located in India, not Nairobi, Kenya. The Union Cabinet officially approved its establishment in early 2024, cementing India's leadership in global wildlife conservation (similar to its role in the International Solar Alliance).

Q 132. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Angikaar 2025 campaign launched under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana – Urban 2.0 (PMAY-U 2.0). Its primary goal is to accelerate the scheme's implementation by fast-tracking application verification, ensuring the completion of previously sanctioned houses, and reaching vulnerable urban populations across more than 5,000 Urban Local Bodies (ULBs).
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The objective of Angikaar 2025 campaign is to disseminate information and create widespread awareness about the Credit Risk Guarantee Fund Trust for Low Income Housing (CRGFTLIH). This trust is crucial because it provides credit risk coverage (up to 70%) to banks and lending institutions, making it easier for Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) and Low-Income Groups (LIG)—who often lack collateral—to secure home loans.

Q 133. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The India MedTech Expo 2025 was organized by the Department of Pharmaceuticals (under the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers) in close association with the Export Promotion Council for Medical Devices (EPCMD). The event was hosted at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The event was the proactive role of the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) under the MedTech Mitra initiative. During the expo, the CDSCO granted test licenses to various start-ups and innovators to accelerate the clinical testing and regulatory approval process for indigenous medical devices.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The event saw widespread participation and endorsement from all major industry bodies, including AIMED (Association of Indian Medical Device Industry), FICCI, CII, and NATHEALTH, showcasing a collaborative effort to boost domestic manufacturing and reduce import dependency in the medical device sector.

Q 134. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Assertion (A) is True:** The Ministry of Tribal Affairs officially launched the beta version of the “Adi Sanskriti” digital platform in September 2025 during the National Conference on Adi Karmayogi Abhiyan at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.
- **Reason (R) is True and explains (A):** The Ministry launched this digital learning platform because it is explicitly envisioned to evolve into the world’s first Digital University dedicated to tribal knowledge and culture. The architecture of this platform integrates three distinct but complementary pillars to achieve this vision:
 - ✓ **Adi Vishwavidyalaya (Digital Tribal Art Academy):** Functions as the core e-learning center offering immersive digital courses on tribal painting, crafts, music, dance, and folklore.
 - ✓ **Adi Sampada (Socio-Cultural Repository):** Acts as a massive digital archive to digitally map and preserve thousands of curated documents, artifacts, and oral histories of tribal heritage.
 - ✓ **Adi Haat (Digital Marketplace):** Serves as an e-commerce interface (currently linked with TRIFED) designed to eliminate middlemen, allowing tribal artisans to sell their products directly to a global audience.

Q 135. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **28th Universal Postal Congress (UAE):** The United Arab Emirates won the bid to host the 28th session of the Universal Postal Union (UPU) Congress. The event was scheduled to take place at the Dubai World Trade Centre.
- **SCO Summit 2025 (China):** After assuming the rotating presidency, China hosted the 25th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Heads of State Council meeting in Tianjin
- **2nd Global Spiritual Tourism Conclave (Madhya Pradesh):** Organized by the PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry (PHDCCI) in collaboration with the Ministry of Tourism, this conclave (titled “Ruhmantic”) was held in the holy city of Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh to discuss faith-based travel and wellness.
- **68th Commonwealth Parliamentary Conference (Barbados):** The 68th annual gathering of the Commonwealth Parliamentary Association (CPA) was hosted by the Parliament of Barbados in Bridgetown.

Q 136. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Marium Fatima from Bihar has achieved a remarkable milestone by becoming the state’s first Woman FIDE Master (WFM). A brilliant chess player from Bihar, Marium, belongs to Muzaffarpur. She has earned several accolades in the sport of chess.
- The WFM title is a massive breakthrough for Bihar, marking the first time in the state’s history that a woman has reached this level in international chess.

Q 137. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The inaugural Khelo India Water Sports Festival 2025 was held at the iconic Dal Lake in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir. The event featured Olympic-level competitions in kayaking, canoeing, rowing, and other water sports.
- Madhya Pradesh dominated the competition, topping the overall medal tally to win the championship trophy. Their athletes won a total of 18 medals (10 gold, 3 silver, and 5 bronze). Their dominance was particularly evident in the kayaking and canoeing events.
- Odisha secured the runner-up position, finishing second with 10 medals (4 gold, 5 silver, 1 bronze).
- Kerala finished in third place with 7 medals (3 gold, 1 silver, 3 bronze).

Q 138. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The GII is published annually by the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), a specialized agency of the United Nations. Switzerland retained the number one spot globally, followed by Sweden (2nd) and the United States (3rd).
- **Statement 2 is correct:** In the Global Innovation Index 2025, India continued its upward trajectory, improving its rank to the 38th position globally out of 139 economies (up from 39th in 2024). Furthermore, India retains a strong presence in regional innovation ecosystems, with Bengaluru ranking 21st globally, placing it well within the top 50 science and technology innovation clusters. Other Indian cities like Delhi, Mumbai, and Chennai also feature in the top 100 global clusters.

Q 139. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Assertion (A) is True:** The Delhi Legislative Assembly officially became the first legislature in India to run entirely on solar energy. This milestone was achieved with the commissioning of a 500-kilowatt rooftop solar power plant on the assembly premises, which is expected to not only meet the assembly's energy needs (bringing its electricity bill to zero) but also generate surplus electricity to feed into the national grid.
- **Reason (R) is False:** The International Solar Alliance (ISA) is a treaty-based intergovernmental organization, and its membership is strictly composed of sovereign countries, not individual cities or states/union territories within a country.

Q 140. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The Union Cabinet approved the Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses (2025–26 to 2030–31) with an outlay of ₹11,440 crore to achieve self-sufficiency in pulses production. The mission mainly focuses on Tur, Urad, and Masoor pulses.
- The scheme aims to raise pulses production to 350 lakh tonnes by 2030–31 and provides 100% MSP procurement, free seed kits, certified seeds, and value chain support to benefit nearly 2 crore farmers.

Q 141. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Ajay Kumar Bhalla :** A senior bureaucrat and former Union Home Secretary, he was recently appointed as the Governor of Nagaland.
- **Urjit Patel :** The former Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) represents India as an Executive Director at the IMF.
- **Rajiv Ranjan :** He holds the position of Vice President at the New Development Bank (NDB), the multilateral development bank established by the BRICS states.
- **Hirdesh Kumar :** He is a senior bureaucrat serving as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of NATGRID, India's master intelligence data link for security agencies.

Q 142. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Kapas Kisan App**
 - ✓ The Ministry of Textile launched the Kapas Kisan App a digital solution developed by the Cotton Corporation of India (CCI).
 - ✓ Primary Objective: To digitize and streamline the procurement of cotton under the Minimum Support Price (MSP) scheme.
- **BHARATI Initiative**
 - ✓ The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) launched the BHARATI initiative (Bharat's Hub for Agritech, Resilience, Advancement, and Incubation for Export Enablement) to modernize India's agri-export landscape.
 - ✓ Goal: To empower 100 agri-food and agri-tech startups in its initial pilot cohort (commencing September 2025).
 - ✓ Vision 2030: This is part of a larger strategy to help India reach a \$50 billion export target for scheduled agri-products by 2030.
- **Adi Vaani**
 - ✓ The Ministry of Tribal Affairs launched the Beta Version of Adi Vaani App. It is India's first AI-powered translator specifically designed for tribal languages. It acts as the foundation for a future Large Language Model (LLM) dedicated to indigenous dialects.

Q 143. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Defence Research and Development Organisation

(DRDO) successfully conducted the maiden flight-tests of Integrated Air Defence Weapon System (IADWS) off the coast of Odisha.

● **Integrated Air Defence Weapon System**

- ✓ It is a multi-layered air defence system, which includes three components—
- ✓ Quick Reaction Surface to Air Missiles (QRSAM) developed by DRDO
- ✓ Advanced Very Short Range Air Defence System (VSHORADS) missiles have been developed by Research Centre Imarat (RCI)
- ✓ High-power laser-based Directed Energy Weapon (DEW) by Centre for High Energy Systems and Sciences (CHES)

Q 144. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Union Cabinet approved the continuation/extension of the universal supply of fortified rice under all government schemes, including the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PMGKAY), until December 2028. The initiative aims to provide nutritional security to approximately 80 crore people.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The scheme is a Central Sector initiative, meaning it is 100% funded by the Central Government. The total financial implication for the extension period is estimated at ₹17,082 crore, which is entirely borne by the Centre as part of the food subsidy.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Department of Food and Public Distribution supplies fortified rice containing Iron, Folic Acid, and Vitamin B12 to address anaemia. The primary goal of adding Iron, Folic Acid, and B12 to rice is to combat anaemia and micronutrient deficiencies across the country.

Q 145. Ans. B

Explanation:

- CEREBO is a portable, non-invasive brain injury diagnostic device developed jointly by the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), AIIMS Bhopal, NIMHANS Bengaluru, MDMS, and Bioscan Research. It is designed for detecting Traumatic Brain Injuries (TBIs), including intracranial bleeding and edema, within a minute. The device is safe for infants and pregnant women and can be operated by paramedics as well as unskilled personnel.

Q 146. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The e VITARA is Suzuki's first global strategic Battery Electric Vehicle (BEV). Based on the "eVX" concept shown at Auto Expo 2023, it is designed as a global model to be sold in India, Europe, and Japan. It features the newly developed "HEARTECT-e" platform specifically for electric vehicles.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The vehicle is manufactured at the Suzuki Motor Gujarat (SMG) plant in Hansalpur, Ahmedabad. This facility serves as a primary global production hub; it began mass production in early 2025 to meet both domestic demand and export requirements (including a derivative model for Toyota).

Q 147. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The 'e-Bhavishya' (and the core 'Bhavishya' portal) is an initiative of the Department of Pension & Pensioners' Welfare (DoPPW), which falls under the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions. It helps to combat delay & clerical errors in processing the pension cases, as well as financial loss and harassment to the pensioners.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The initiative is designed specifically for Government employees. Its goal is to ensure that government servants receive their Pension Payment Order (PPO) on the very day of their retirement. It does not cover employees in the private sector, whose pensions and provident funds are managed through the EPFO (EPF and EPS schemes) or the National Pension System (NPS).

Q 148. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy has launched the National Policy on Geothermal Energy to achieve net-zero emissions by 2070.
- Ten geothermal provinces have been identified in India. These include Himalayas, Cambay Basin, Aravalli, Mahanadi basin and Godavari Basin. The estimated potential for geothermal energy in India is about 10.6 Gigawatt.
- The National Policy on Geothermal Energy targets integration of geothermal energy with India's Net Zero and renewable energy goals. There is scope for diverse applications, including electricity generation and space heating and cooling, agriculture, tourism and desalination.

Q 149. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Flying Wedge Defence and Aerospace (FWDA) has rolled out Kaala Bhairav, India's first fully indigenous AI-powered Medium Altitude Long Endurance (MALE) combat aircraft. The Bengaluru firm has already secured a \$25 million export order from a South Asian nation, part of a \$30 million deal. With 30-hour endurance, 3000 km range and swarm strike capability, the drone is built at one-tenth the cost of U.S. Predator systems. Developed under Atmanirbhar Bharat, Kaala Bhairav reduces foreign dependence and positions India as a defence exporter.

Q 150. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Carlos Alcaraz secured his first Cincinnati Open title after the defending champion, Jannik Sinner, was forced to retire in the final due to illness/physical discomfort while Alcaraz was leading 5–0 in the first set. This victory marked Alcaraz's 22nd career ATP title.

- World No. 1 Iga Swiatek won her first Cincinnati Open title by defeating Jasmine Paolini 7–5, 6–4 in the final. Notably, Swiatek did not drop a single set throughout the entire tournament.
- The veteran duo of Nikola Mektić and Rajeev Ram captured the title by defeating the Italian pair Lorenzo Musetti and Lorenzo Sonego in the final with a score of 4–6, 6–3, [10–5]. At 41 years old, Rajeev Ram became one of the oldest players to win a Masters 1000 doubles title.

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Chauraha, Patna,
Bihar-800001

Naya Tola

KP Yadav
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